

n+1 Social Foundation ANNUAL REPORT 2025-26

Learning. Measuring. Improving.

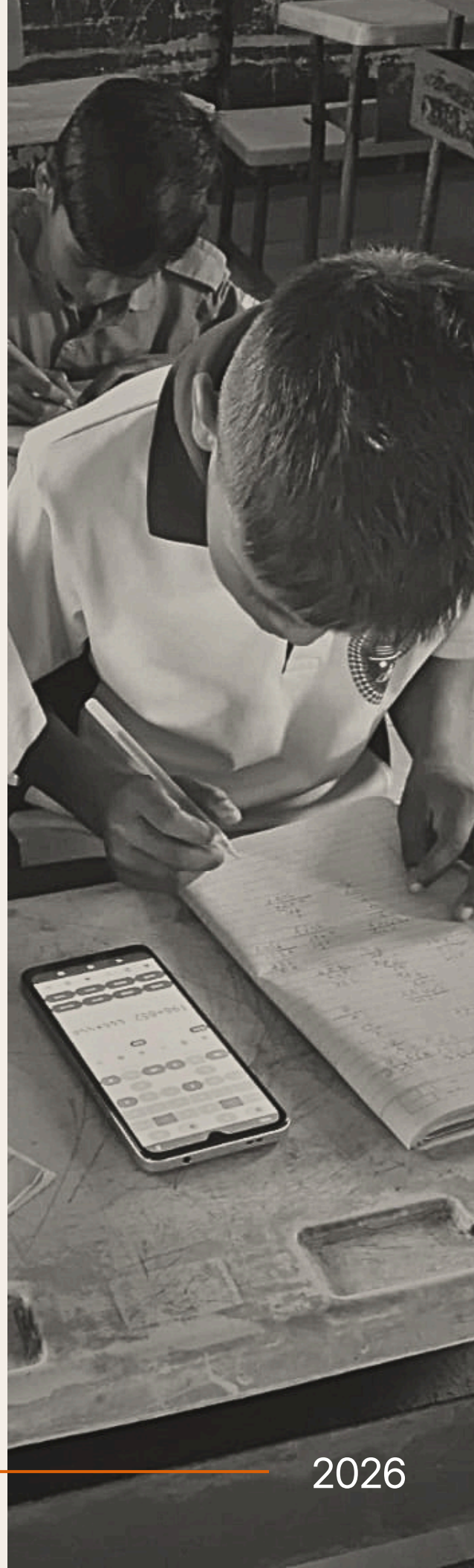


Foundational Literacy | Foundational Numeracy | Innovation | Research

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2025-26 at a glance

A year of reading, numbers, questions and learning.

387 Read-a-story students	500 Read-a-story volunteers	6,282 Reading hours
7,500+ Solve-with-Bharat students expanded programme	43 Core intervention schools Solve-with-Bharat	39 Community Facilitators Solve-with-Bharat

37.6% RAS students improved <i>among evaluated students</i>	11 crore Maths problems solved July 2025 - March 2026	1.25 Effect size Solve-with-Bharat	Up to 99% Paper Plus accuracy <i>testing phase</i>
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The numbers tell part of the story. The pages ahead tell the rest.



A letter from the Founders

Every year, our programs teach us something new.

Sometimes it is something we see in a child - a new word read independently, a maths problem solved without help, or simply the confidence to put up a hand and try.

Sometimes the lesson comes from the data.

And sometimes it comes from something that did not go as planned.

At n+1, we work with children from underserved communities to strengthen foundational literacy and numeracy. We do this through programs that combine people, technology and practice, but we also know that these things only work when they fit the lives of the children and communities we work with.

This year, Read-a-story connected 387 children with 500 volunteers. Volunteers contributed more than 6,200 hours of reading. Solve-with-Bharat worked with thousands of children in tribal schools in Talasari, supported by local Community Facilitators and mobile technology.

The numbers are important. But they only tell part of the story.

Behind them are children with very different starting points, volunteers learning how to work with a child one-to-one, Community Facilitators taking on their first professional roles, teachers trying to make room for another programme in busy school days, and a team constantly working out what can be improved.

Our work is not without challenges. Children miss sessions. Schools have interruptions. Internet access is not always dependable. Some interventions work better than others. We have learnt to treat these as part of the work rather than as something to overlook.

One of the things we value most at n+1 is evidence. We want to know whether children are learning, not just whether a programme has been delivered. That is why our programs include assessment, monitoring and reflection as part of the work itself.

This year also gave us opportunities to test new ideas, strengthen our research partnerships and develop Paper Plus, our attempt to take numeracy practice beyond the school and the phone. There is still a great deal to learn.

That is not a problem. It is part of why we are here.

Thank you to the children, families, volunteers, Community Facilitators, teachers, schools, funders and partners who have been part of the year.

About n+1 Social Foundation

n+1 Social Foundation works to improve foundational literacy and numeracy among children from marginalised communities, including tribal and migrant communities in Maharashtra.

Our starting point is simple. Children need strong foundations in reading, understanding and mathematics if they are to make good use of everything that comes later in school.

But children do not all begin from the same place. Some have fewer opportunities to practise. Some are learning in a language they do not speak at home. Some are in classrooms where teachers have many children and many responsibilities. Some simply need more time and individual attention.

Our programs try to respond to these realities.

Read-a-story supports English reading and spoken communication through one-to-one sessions with volunteers.

Solve-with-Bharat supports foundational numeracy through structured mathematics practice, mobile technology and local Community Facilitators.

Paper Plus is being developed as an extension of Solve-with-Bharat, allowing children to practise through worksheets and WhatsApp when school-based digital practice is not possible.

Alongside these programs, n+1 invests in research, partnerships and new ideas. We do not expect every experiment to become a programme. Sometimes the value of an experiment is simply that it helps us understand what works better.

Our Vision

To improve learning gains in foundational literacy and numeracy among marginalised children, including tribal and migrant communities, across Maharashtra.

Our Mission

To demonstrate, at scale, learning gains in foundational literacy and numeracy that are statistically and practically significant.

Our Values

RESPECT

Respect

We respect children, families, teachers, volunteers and communities and the experiences they bring to the work.

Trust

Our programs depend on trust - between a child and a volunteer, a Community Facilitator and a school, and between n+1 and the communities we work with.

Evidence-based Development

We measure learning, study what the results tell us and use that information to improve our programs.



READ-A-STORY

More than learning to read.

387 students | 500 volunteers | 6,282 hours



Read-a-story

More than learning to read

Read-a-story began with a simple idea: connect a child with someone who has the time and patience to read with them.

The sessions take place via phone calls and, where possible, online platforms. The child reads aloud from a storybook while the volunteer listens. They discuss words, pronunciation and meaning, and gradually the child becomes more comfortable using English.

The programme is intentionally simple. There is a book, a phone, a volunteer and a child. But what happens within that interaction can be quite different for every student. For one child, it may be the first time someone has listened patiently while she reads in English. For another, it may be a chance to ask questions without worrying about what the rest of the class thinks.

For the volunteer, it may be the first experience of teaching or mentoring someone younger. That makes the programme more personal than a lesson delivered to a group.

2025-26 in numbers

387	500	6,282	274
Students	Volunteers	Reading hours	Students evaluated

Working with institutions

Institution	Volunteers	Hours	Programme period
St. Mary’s Junior College	24	88.86	Aug-Dec 2025
Dr. Kalmadi Shamarao High School	60	95.03	Sep 2025-Jan 2026
SIMS - Cohort 1	200	3,041.34	Sep 2025-Feb 2026
SIMS - Cohort 2	106	1,566.65	Sep 2025-Feb 2026

The 500 volunteers came through both institutional partnerships and the open volunteer programme, bringing together students and adults from different parts of India.

What happened to reading levels?

Reading level change	Students	Percentage
Improved by 1 level	89	32.5%
Improved by 2 levels	13	4.7%
Improved by 3 levels	1	0.4%
No level change	129	47.1%
Moved down by 1 level	34	12.4%
Moved down by 2 levels	8	2.9%

103 students, or 37.6% of those evaluated, moved up by at least one level.

The results also show why it is important to look at more than one number. Some children did not change levels during the year. A few moved down. The programme recorded several reasons: low participation, network and connectivity issues, lack of interest, and students leaving the programme midway.

Different groups, different experiences

Kannada Medium

57 students participated and 43 were evaluated. Fourteen students moved up one level, and two moved up two levels. Fifteen remained at the same level.

Symbiosis Mulshi

38 students participated and 26 were evaluated. Six moved up one level, while thirteen remained at the same level.

Gram Vikas Gatividhi

With 188 students, GVG was the largest student group. 136 students were evaluated. Forty-nine moved up one level, eight moved up two levels, and one student moved up three levels.

Other students

Across the other programme groups, 104 students participated and 69 were evaluated. Twenty moved up one level and three moved up two levels.

The people who make RAS work

Radha Sarahte, Volunteer

Radha participated in Read-a-story for the second year. She wrote about beginning with a new student who was shy and hesitant. Conversations were slow at first. As they started reading stories together, the child began opening up, trying new words and reacting with excitement to the stories.

“Teaching isn’t about rushing or being perfect. It’s about being patient, supportive, and showing up consistently.”

Rukunjeet Singh, Volunteer

Rukunjeet joined Read-a-story through SIMS and worked with an eighth-grade student. Coming from a defence family and with a mother who is a teacher, he had wanted to try teaching himself. His experience gave him a direct look at what that meant in practice.

“This experience with Read-a-story was nothing short of an amazing experience filled with different emotions coming out of both myself and the student.”

Shannon D’Souza, Volunteer

In an earlier RAS cohort, Shannon worked with Pawan Wadekar, an eighth-grade student who started at Level 0 and struggled to read beyond basic words. She used stories and everyday examples to make the sessions engaging. Over time, his reading improved and their sessions became conversations rather than just lessons.

“This experience wasn’t just about teaching - it was a journey of mutual growth.”

Student voices

Shraddha Nagraj Badiger

Shraddha, a Grade 9 student, wrote that her volunteer helped her learn how to read English and pronounce words correctly.

Anjali Shankar Murale

Anjali wrote that she could read English before joining RAS but often did not understand explanations in English. She now feels that her English has improved and that her interest in the language has increased.

Soumya Vilas Dase

Soumya described being uncomfortable speaking English fluently before joining the programme. She says she is now more confident and has developed a greater interest in English.

TESTIMONIALS



This program not only supported the child's language development but also helped me strengthen my communication skills. Through this experience, I learned how to explain ideas clearly, adjust my pace based on the learner's responses, and keep sessions engaging in an online setting. Over time, I became more patient and confident, and more comfortable guiding conversations naturally. I'm genuinely thankful to the platform for this opportunity, as it provided me with practical teaching experience and meaningful exposure to working with young learners.

*Regards,
Aisha Hamdan
St Mary's School, Pune*



"I had an amazing time volunteering with the read-a-story initiative with n+1 social foundation, got this opportunity to teach a very bright student named Prajakta, she was a very enthusiastic, quick learner and ready to learn new things. This initiative gave me a meaningful opportunity to contribute to this initiative and make an impact in the society."

*Ruchika Bisht
SIMS College*



"Supporting a student through Read a Story has been a deeply fulfilling experience. The initiative not only creates access to education but also builds hope and confidence in young learners. It is inspiring to be associated with an organisation that is making a tangible difference at the grassroots level."

Thank you once again for allowing me to contribute to such a meaningful cause.

*Regards,
Aditya Kowtha
SIMS College*



Dear Team Read-a-story,

I am writing this email to you so that I can share with you some information about my experience of volunteering with your organisation. I have recently completed my 12-hour volunteer course as a student of SMJC.

It was a wonderful experience working with the students and the team. The students were really sincere and hardworking, displaying an eagerness and an exceptional ability to learn; making my interactions with them very satisfying.

The Read-a-story team was extremely helpful and supportive, and was always available to assist in facilitating coordination with the student; enabling my journey through this program to run smoothly and efficiently. I would like to extend a special appreciation for Mr. Vinayak, who tirelessly worked towards making my sessions with my student possible.

*Thank you,
Yours faithfully,
Kaira Manglani
St. Mary's Junior College*

Mudita - An Alliance for Giving

Through a collaboration with Mudita - An Alliance for Giving, Read-a-story worked with 13 young people pursuing higher education in areas including technology, engineering, and nursing. Volunteers worked with students on spoken English, communication, and interview preparation. Twelve students completed the endline assessment.

The majority of students scored above 35 out of 50 at end-line, with encouraging results in listening, spoken response and confidence. The experience also gave us a chance to test whether the one-to-one volunteer model could support students beyond school-level reading.

13

Students Participated

12

Students evaluated

"I picked up a lot of things from the volunteers - how to improve my English skills, remember new words, and get better at spelling."

Pranisha Pol, Mudita

What we learnt



Individual attention matters

A child who may hesitate to speak in a group can behave quite differently when speaking to one person. Volunteers learn as much about patience, explanation and communication as the students do. The programme also remains affected by connectivity, access to devices, participation and dropouts. The next challenge is to improve the programme without losing the simple part that makes it work: one child and one volunteer having enough space to read, talk and learn together.

SOLVE-WITH-BHARAT

Learning mathematics through practice

7,500+ students | 43 core schools | 39 Community Facilitators

11 crore sums solved



Solve-with-Bharat

Learning mathematics through practice

For many children in rural and tribal schools, mathematics becomes difficult because the basic operations are not yet secure. Addition, subtraction, multiplication, and division are not glamorous skills. But they are the building blocks for almost everything that comes later in mathematics.

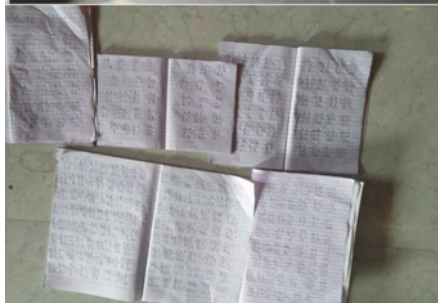
Solve-with-Bharat is built around a practical idea: children need a lot of opportunities to solve problems. The programme combines mobile technology with local Community Facilitators. The phones provide structured practice. The facilitator helps the child understand the problem, stay engaged, and work at an appropriate level.

Introduction

This program supports tribal children in grades 2 through 6, as well as students in 7th and 8th grade when possible, in improving their foundational numeracy skills. The focus is on the four basic operations:

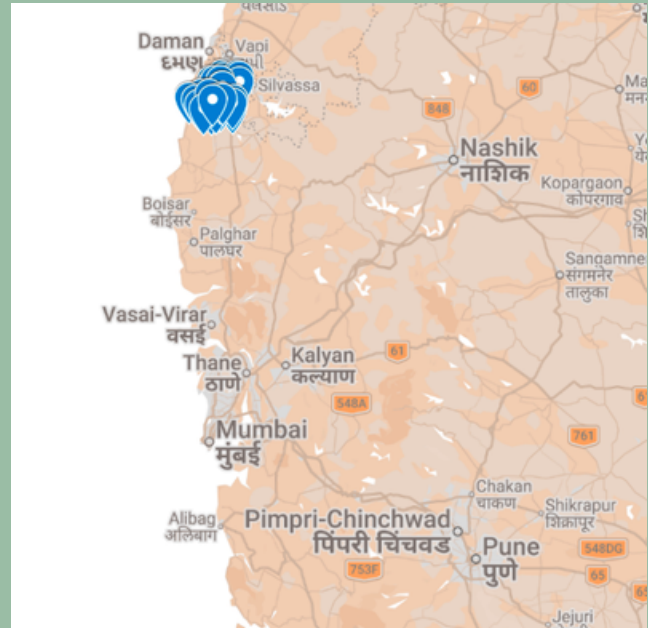
- Addition
- Subtraction
- Multiplication
- Division

We select and train over 40 local facilitators, who are either college or high school graduates. These facilitators are provided with mobile phones equipped with a practice application. Using this app, they conduct practice sessions with groups of 20 to 40 students at a time. These sessions reinforce the concepts being taught, and the facilitators assist students whenever they encounter difficulties. This personalized and differentiated learning approach combines the advantages of technology with the essential human touch.

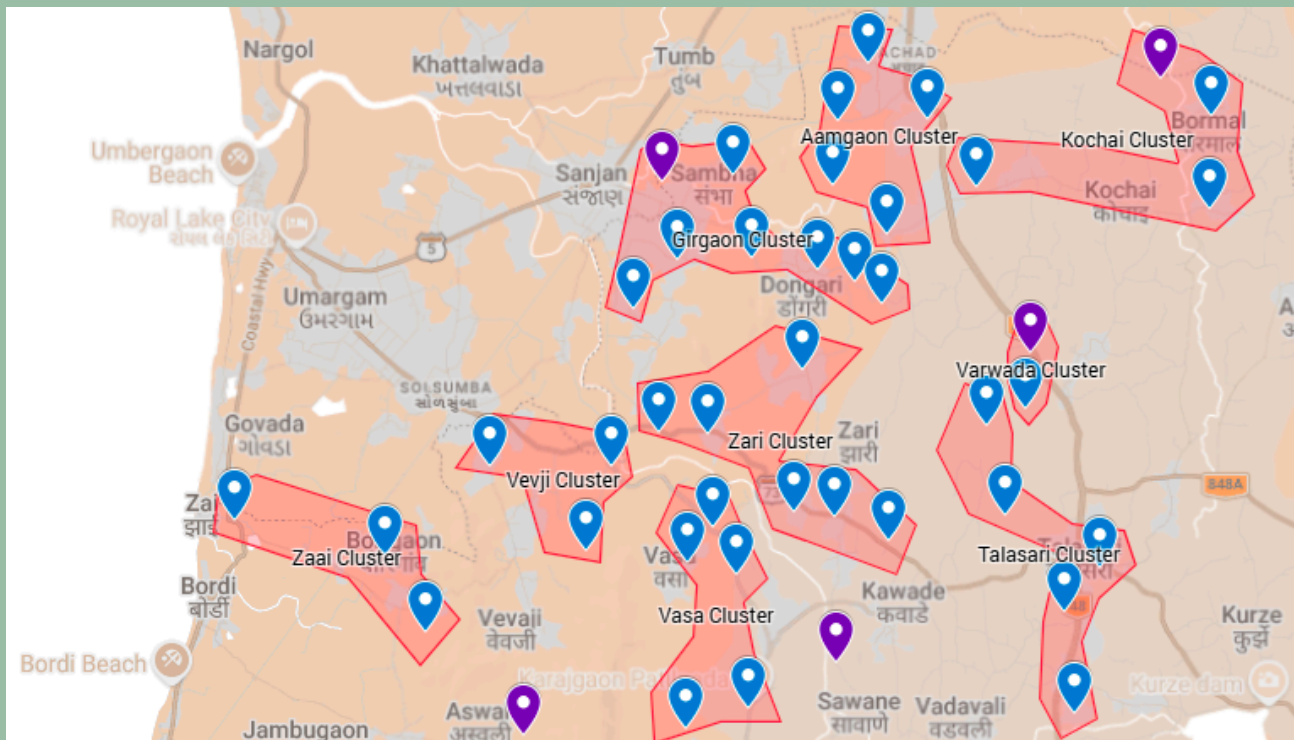


Solve-with-Bharat

Location



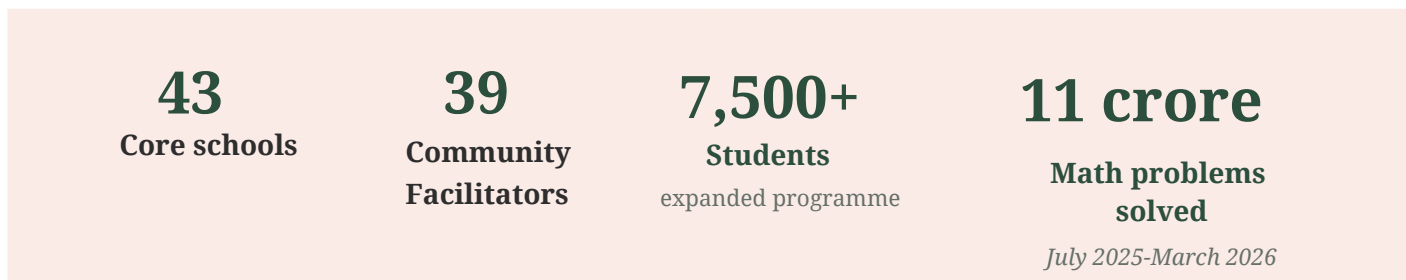
The programme operated across clusters in Talasari, Palghar, including Zari, Girgaon, Vevji, Vasa, Talasari, Aamgaon, Kochai, Varwada and Zai.



Blue - Z. P. Schools Purple - Govt. Ashram Schools

Solve-with-Bharat

The program in 2025-26



Two Pillars of Intervention

- **Community Facilitators**

Community Facilitators are recruited locally. Many are college students or graduates, and some are former students of the schools where they now work. They receive training in basic pedagogy and digital skills. Each facilitator works with groups of students and uses mobile phones loaded with the maths practice app.

- **Mobile practice**

The app can be configured for different mathematical operations, difficulty levels and numbers of questions. Students first solve problems on paper and then select the answer on the phone. This keeps the calculation itself with the child rather than turning the activity into simple guessing.'

Monitoring and Data-Driven Insights

The program utilizes a rigorous tracking system to ensure that no student is left behind. CFs record the number of sums solved by every student in every session in a physical logbook. This data is rolled up weekly into Google Sheets, allowing the program team to analyze trends, monitor efficiency and identify specific students who are falling behind. For the 2025-26 student body of 7500+, this equates to a target of approximately 30 lakh sums per week.

Research Activities

Our quasi-experimental RCT design, conducted last academic year (2024-25), titled "Enhancing Foundational Numeracy in Tribal Students via Technology and Community Facilitators: A Quasi-Experimental Study," was submitted to the prestigious "T4E" or International Conference on Technology 4 Education 2025, organized by the EdTech Society in December at IIT Madras in Chennai, India.

It was accepted and presented by us at the conference. It was received with great interest, and students, researchers, and other social impact practitioners expressed interest in collaboration and further research.

How much did students practise?

Around 11 crore maths problems were solved between July 2025 and March 2026.

The programme set a target of 420 sums per student per week. Across the expanded programme, this translated into a very large amount of planned practice. During July-October, average efficiency was 58%. After Diwali, from November to March, it increased to 132%. The internal report estimates that the **average student solved more than 14,000 sums through the programme.**

Measuring learning

Students were assessed using the same 32 questions across eight categories: addition without carry, addition with carry, subtraction without borrowing, subtraction with borrowing, simple multiplication tables, harder multiplication tables, multiplication and division. Assessments were conducted at baseline, followed by six formative assessments and an endline assessment.

What happened to scores?

Assessment	Mean score	Gain over baseline
Baseline	13.14	-
FA1	18.50	40.8%
FA2	19.50	48.4%
FA3	21.60	64.4%
FA4	22.60	72.0%
FA5	23.20	76.6%
FA6	23.70	80.4%
Endline	25.60	94.8%

Endline mean score: 25.6 | Learning gain: 94.8% | Effect size: 1.25

Which maths skills improved?

Students improved across all eight areas. The harder areas - division, multiplication and subtraction with borrowing - were also among those showing the largest relative gains: approximately 2.8x growth in division, 3x growth in multiplication and 2.2x growth in subtraction with borrowing.

Other models we tried

Mobile CF Pilot

The Mobile CF model was designed for smaller, single-teacher schools that are harder to cover with a full-time facilitator. One facilitator visits different schools during the week. The pilot covered around 400 students across 10 schools. It produced visible learning gains, with an effect size of 0.57, but the gains were smaller than in the main intervention. One important difference was frequency: students had access to practice only once a week.

Contract Teacher Pilot

n+1 also tested whether the model could be run with contract teachers in smaller Zilla Parishad schools: the Aamgaon cluster: Acchad Devipada, Aamgaon Dongaripada, Uplat Thakarpada and Uplat Patilpada.

Four teachers initially participated. Three eventually opted out because of their existing workload. One teacher continued and incorporated the programme into her timetable. The experience showed that any model added to a teacher's workload needs its own time and role to be designed carefully.

Anvir and YRF

n+1 also worked with Yashraj Research Foundation in the neighbouring village of Anvir. n+1 provided the phones, and YRF provided the Community Facilitators. The programme covered 147 students across four schools, with baseline and endline assessments over nine months.

Monitoring and Data-Driven Insights

The program employs a rigorous tracking system to ensure that no student is left behind. Community Facilitators (CFs) record the number of sums solved by each student during every session in a physical logbook. This data is compiled weekly into Google Sheets, enabling the program team to analyze trends, monitor efficiency, and identify specific students who may be falling behind. For the 2025-26 student body of over 7,500, the program aims for approximately 30 Lakh sums solved each week.

Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E)

In addition to regular monitoring, which involves reviewing outputs weekly to observe trends and identify struggling students, evaluations are conducted for all students at baseline and then sampled at regular intervals. The three programs employed different evaluation strategies as follows:

- **Solve-With-Bharat Program Outcomes:** Evaluation of all students was conducted at baseline, followed by six formative assessments (FA1-FA6) spaced approximately one month apart throughout the year, culminating in an endline evaluation.
- **Mobile CF Pilot:** Evaluation of all students began with a baseline assessment, followed by three formative assessments.
- **Partnership with Yashraj Research Foundation (YRF) for Anvir Village:** All 125 students were evaluated at baseline and again at endline.

Assessments

The baseline, formative assessments, and endline evaluations are administered using a consistent set of 32 sums across 8 categories, which include:

1. Addition with no carry
2. Addition with carry
3. Subtraction with no borrow
4. Subtraction with borrow
5. Simple multiplication table
6. Harder multiplication table
7. Harder multiplication
8. Division

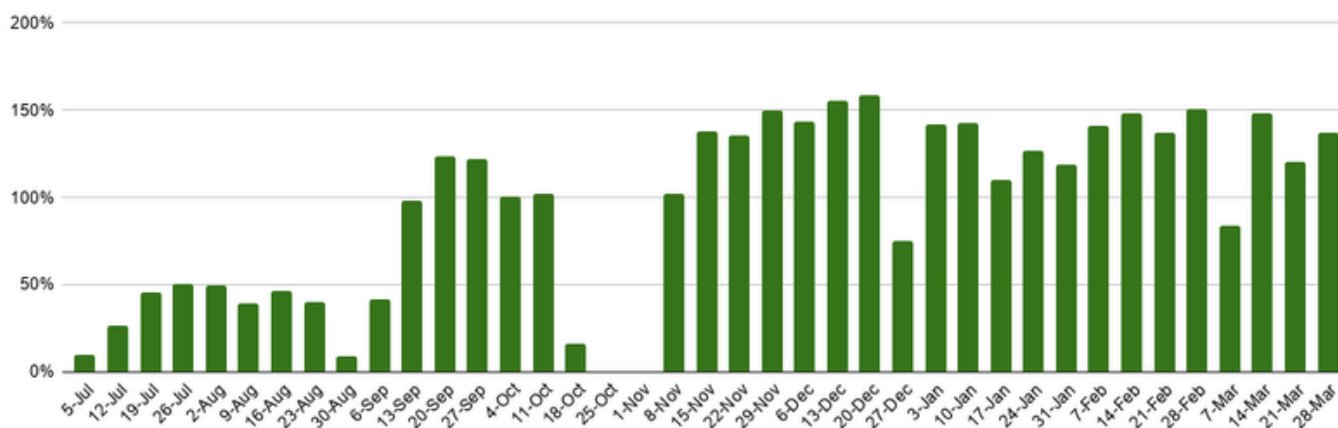
Students can choose to take the assessments in either Marathi or English, based on their comfort level. They are given one hour to complete the assessments and are encouraged to use their books as rough notebooks. Proctoring is provided by the Community Facilitators (CFs). After the assessments, CFs collect, grade, and upload the data into a shared Google Sheet for analysis. Absent students are also noted and marked.

Practice Output

For Solve-with-Bharat intervention schools, a target of 420 sums per student per week was set. For the 7500+ students in the program, this translates to approximately 30 lakh sums per week. This year, we achieved our target of 100% average efficiency for 2025-26. Between July-October 2025 (before Diwali vacations), our average efficiency was 58%, while between November-March (after Diwali vacations), our average efficiency improved to 132%.

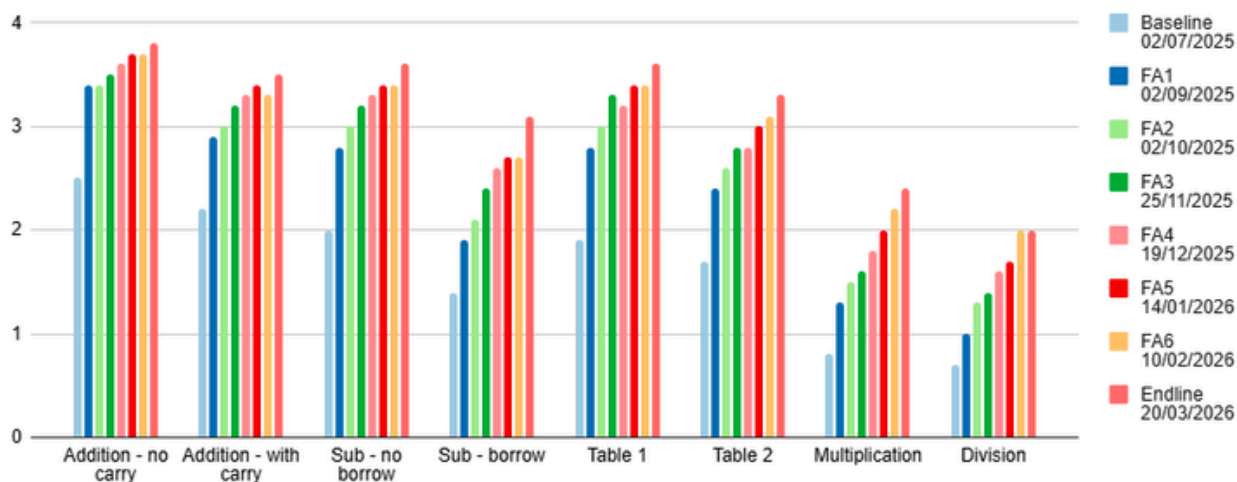
Across the duration of the intervention (July 2025 to March 2026), students in our program solved a combined total of around 11 crore sums. On average, each student solved 14,000+ sums due to our intervention.

SWB 2025-26 - % Complete Per Week



Competencies Improvement

Competencies Improvement



The chart above shows the fine grain operations that students have improved over time. The maximum marks in each category is 4. The eight categories are:

The Eight categories are:

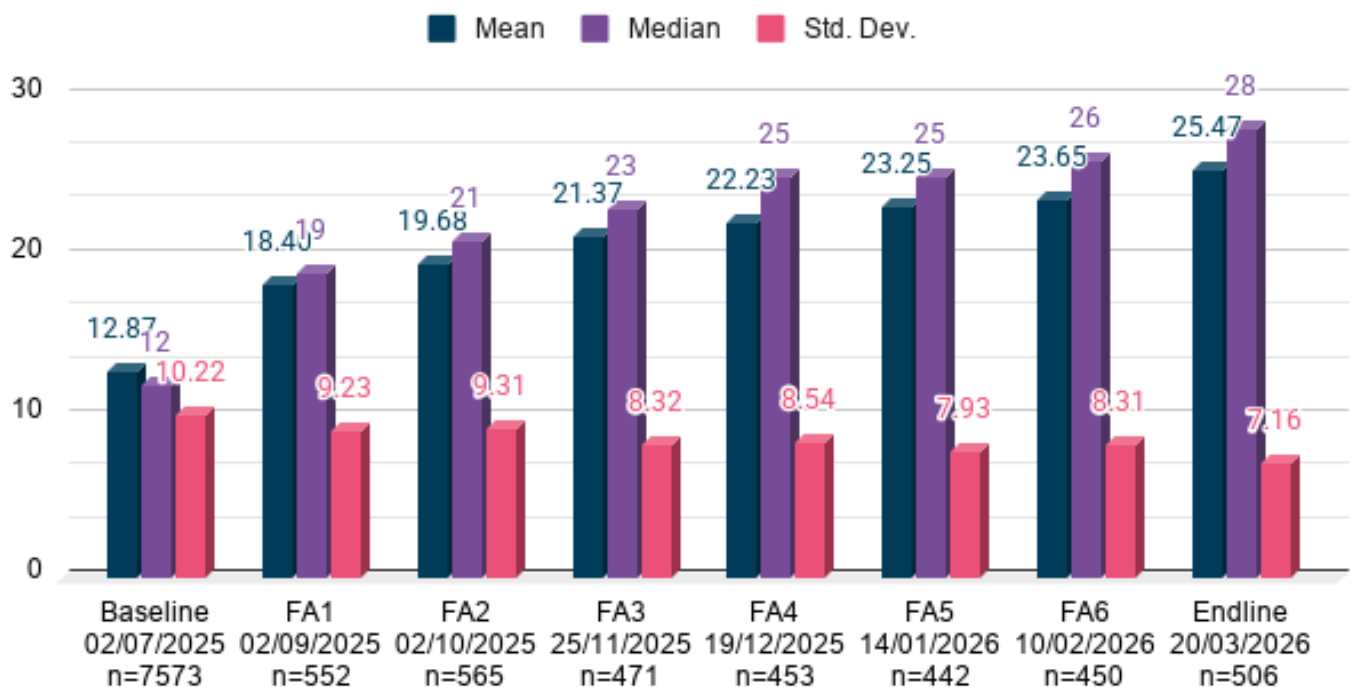
1. Addition with no carry
2. Addition with carry
3. Subtraction with no borrow
4. Subtraction with borrow
5. Simple one-digit multiplication table
6. Harder one-digit multiplication table
7. Multiplication
8. Division

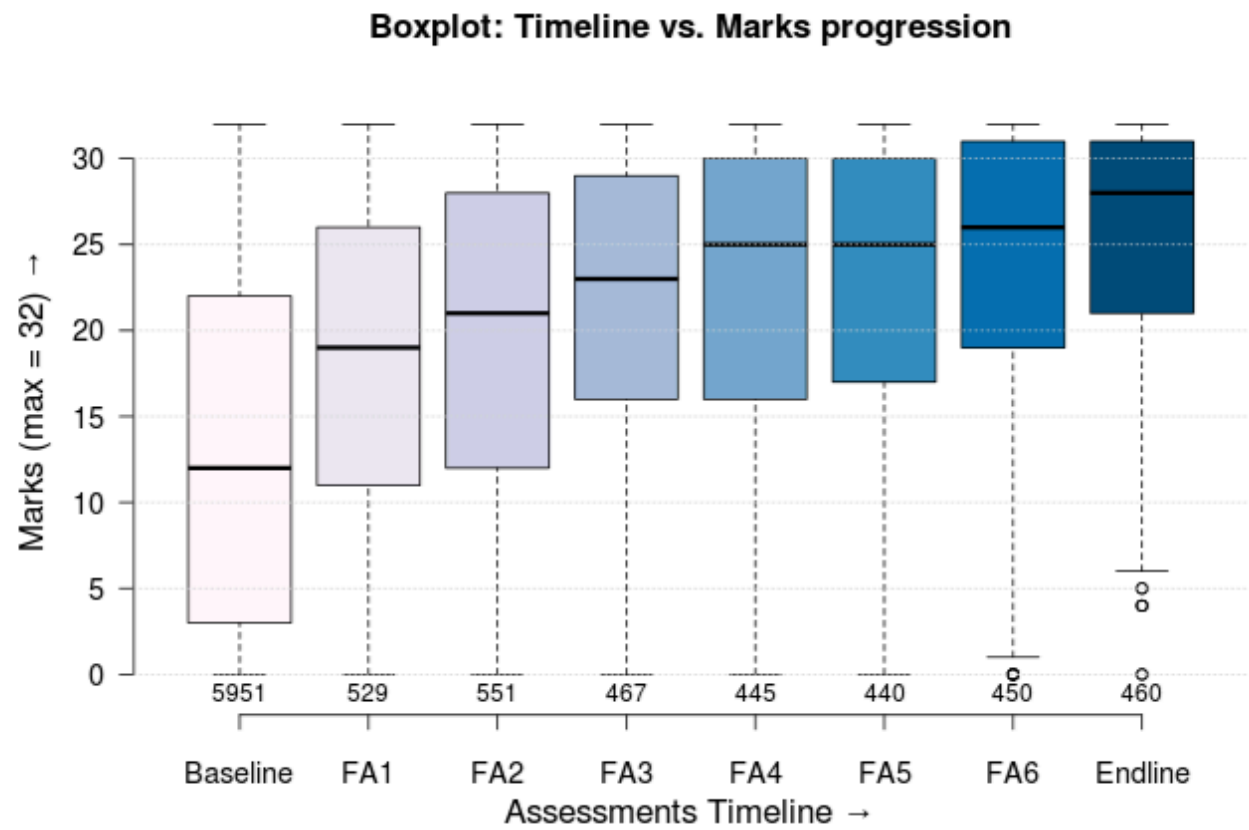
We have observed that students have improved across each of the operations over time.

However, students tend to struggle more with division, multiplication, and subtraction with borrowing. This difficulty may stem from the fact that division and multiplication are generally more complex than addition and subtraction, as they require a solid understanding of basic addition and subtraction, as well as knowledge of multiplication tables and algorithmic procedures.

Interestingly, these three challenging operations are also the areas where students have shown the most significant growth in test scores throughout our program: a 2.8 times increase for division, a 3 times increase for multiplication, and a 2.2 times increase for subtraction.

SWB 2025-26: Assessment Scores





Box plot statistics

	Baseline	FA1	FA2	FA3	FA4	FA5	FA6	Endline
Upper whisker	32.00	32.00	32.00	32.00	32.00	32.00	32.00	32.00
3rd quartile	22.00	26.00	28.00	29.00	30.00	30.00	31.00	31.00
Median	12.00	19.00	21.00	23.00	25.00	25.00	26.00	28.00
1st quartile	3.00	11.00	12.00	16.00	16.00	17.00	19.00	21.00
Lower whisker	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	1.00	6.00
Nr. of data points	5951.00	529.00	551.00	467.00	445.00	440.00	450.00	460.00

What is our long-term goal?

Enhanced Proficiency in Middle School Mathematics: We aim to strengthen foundational math skills to improve students' performance in middle school math, addressing existing weaknesses in this area.

Alignment of Educational Pathways with Market Demands: We are committed to guiding students toward various educational paths—such as diplomas and nursing programs—that are in high demand, moving away from traditional streams that may not align with current job market needs.

Employment Opportunities and Upward Mobility: Our goal is to ensure that students develop the literacy and numeracy skills necessary to secure jobs that offer potential for financial and professional advancement, helping to break the cycle in which dropouts remain in low-paying positions due to lack of skills.

The people behind Solve-with-Bharat

Rajni Thakare

Rajni completed Grade 12 in the Science stream and joined as a Community Facilitator at Zilla Parishad School, Vadvali Punervasan. It was her first job. She wrote about learning to take responsibility, adapt to new situations and complete work even when it was demanding. She also noticed that working with children on multiplication had improved her own ability to recall tables.

“A first job is not only about earning money; it also helps shape one’s personality and confidence.”

Vandana Thakare

Vandana noticed that some children immediately understood the mobile-based work while others struggled. Instead of treating the whole group in the same way, she grouped students according to their ability, worked more closely with those who needed help and used the blackboard to explain problems. Over time, she saw students improve their counting skills and develop more interest in mathematics.

“The students’ perspective towards mathematics changed, and they received a proper platform to learn and practise.”

What the programme taught us

Solve-with-Bharat has given us strong evidence that structured practice can improve foundational numeracy. It has also given us a clearer view of what makes the model work. The Community Facilitator matters. The amount of practice matters. The way practice is organised matters. And the school context matters. When a model works in one setting, that does not automatically mean it will work in another. That is why the pilots are important.

What are the wider benefits of our work?

Community facilitators in the Foundational Numeracy program are not just educators; they are gaining valuable life skills that enhance their employability in multiple ways.

1. Professional & Communication Skills

Facilitators develop effective communication, leadership, and teamwork abilities. They learn how to engage young learners, explain concepts clearly, and manage group dynamics—skills that are transferable to many professional settings, including teaching, training, and customer service roles.

2. Digital & Technological Literacy

By using the math practice app, facilitators gain hands-on experience with ed-tech tools, mobile learning platforms, and data tracking systems. This familiarity with technology is a key skill in today's job market, making them better prepared for roles in education, administration, or even digital customer support.

3. Financial Independence & Responsibility

The stipend provides them with financial confidence and teaches them how to manage their own expenses. This early exposure to financial planning and independence helps them build essential life skills that are crucial for long-term career growth.

4. Problem-Solving & Critical Thinking

Since facilitators work with students of varying abilities, they develop adaptability, patience, and creative problem-solving skills—highly valued in corporate jobs, government positions, and entrepreneurship.

5. Exposure to Structured Work Environments

Facilitators follow a structured schedule, maintain records, and report progress, which prepares them for professional work settings, whether in education, NGOs, or corporate roles.

6. Competitive exams with the government

Some of the facilitators appear for various competitive exams such as, TET, CTET, Maha-TET, Railway, Police, Talathi, Forest guard, IBPS, MPSC, and more. The stipend provides them with the flexibility to earn, study, and appear for these exams (as many are in the cities).

By gaining these skills, community facilitators improve their chances of securing jobs in teaching, government programs, NGOs, education technology, and even customer service roles. This experience makes them well-rounded professionals, increasing their employability beyond their immediate community.



Paper Plus

Taking numeracy practice beyond the school day

Paper Plus grew out of a practical problem. Solve-with-Bharat works well when students have access to in-school practice. But schools have holidays, other activities, and days when a facilitator cannot conduct a session. The question was: how do we keep the practice going?

Paper Plus combines printed worksheets with WhatsApp. Children can complete a worksheet at home or during holidays and send a photograph of the completed page to a WhatsApp number printed on the worksheet. It does not require a separate app and is designed for settings where reliable internet cannot be assumed.

Building the system

The team tested existing scanning and AI solutions, but these did not work reliably on photographs taken in real-world conditions. The team therefore developed its own approach. Fiducial markers improved page detection, and combining this with AI models for identifying student responses increased processing accuracy to up to 99% for pen marks in testing.

Early prototypes focused on structured worksheets with clear bounding boxes for student responses, i.e. input standardization. Initially, complex rule-based image processing techniques were developed and used, working reasonably well for dark pen inputs and clear/well-taken pictures of worksheets, but failing for low contrast, camera distortions / blurring and variable lighting - all of which are to be reasonably expected - giving us an average processing accuracy of 65-75% in real-world settings.

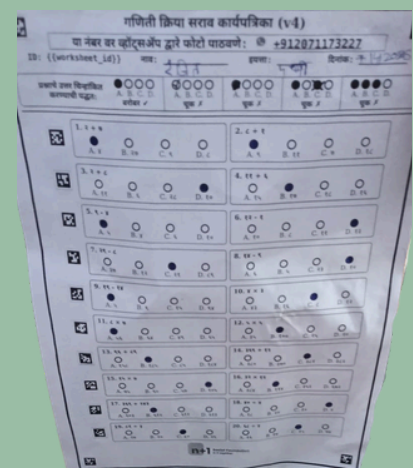
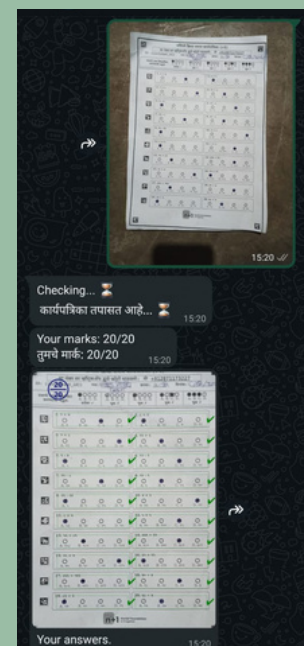
An innovation used to improve accuracy drastically was incorporating fiducial markers - a technology normally used in augmented reality (AR) and robotics applications - into our worksheets. These enabled reliable and robust page boundary detection, and improved our worksheet processing accuracy dramatically.

Another breakthrough was combining the page and question boundary detection accuracy provided by fiducial markers with AI models for identifying student question attempts.

Combined, these two innovations improved our worksheet processing accuracy to up to 99% for pen marks.

Pictured here is a worksheet successfully processed by our improved worksheet processing system.

In the next academic year, we plan to run pilot experiments for new foundational numeracy practice models incorporating this technology.



Innovation at n+1

Not every new idea needs to become a program

Innovation at n+1 often starts with an operational question. How can children practise when there is no facilitator? How can a Community Facilitator cover a school that is too small for a full-time model? How can we understand a child's learning without adding another burden to teachers? How can we get young people to look at education problems differently?

Some of these questions become new programme models. Some become tools. Some simply help us understand what not to do. We think all of these have a place.

Innovate for Education - I4E

During 2025-26, n+1 developed Innovate for Education (I4E) as a new initiative built around design thinking and education. The idea is to bring students and young people into contact with real education challenges and give them a chance to understand a problem before rushing towards a solution.

The approach is practical: understand the context, listen to the people involved, define the problem, generate ideas, build a prototype, test it and learn from what happens.

For n+1, I4E creates another kind of learning space. Participants bring skills in design, technology, research, business or communication, while n+1 brings real education problems and field experience. The detailed I4E programme and internship outcomes fall in the next reporting cycle; for 2025-26, the important milestone is that the model was developed and prepared for implementation.

Research and evidence

Research has become an increasingly important part of how n+1 works. We do not want to know only whether a child completed a programme. We want to know whether learning changed, and where possible, why.

Working with IIT Bombay

During the previous academic year, n+1 worked with IIT Bombay on a quasi-experimental randomized controlled trial to examine whether the Solve-with-Bharat intervention caused improvements in foundational numeracy. The study, "Enhancing Foundational Numeracy in Tribal Students via Technology and Community Facilitators: A Quasi-Experimental Study", was submitted to Technology for Education 2025 at IIT Madras, accepted and presented there in December 2025.

The earlier study showed a statistically significant result at the 99% confidence level, with a large effect size of 1.8 over ten months. In 2025-26, sampling across the expanded student group showed a large effect size of 1.25.

The research helps n+1 move from “we think this works” to “we have evidence that it is working, and we can keep asking why.”

Incubation and learning

n+1 continued its association with NSRCEL at IIM Bangalore. The incubation experience has given us access to mentors and people with expertise in impact measurement, government systems and organisational development. It has also given us the chance to step outside our programs and look at the organisation more critically.

That has been useful. The role of an incubator is not only to tell you that your idea is good. Sometimes it is to ask difficult questions. n+1 has benefited from both.

Partnerships

No programme of this size works alone. The year brought together schools, government officials, Community Facilitators, volunteers, research partners, CSR supporters and philanthropic partners.

- Festo India Private Limited
- Finearc Systems
- Rotary Club of Pune, Gandhivahan • Rotary Club of Bombay, Powai
- Antylia Scientific
- IIT Bombay
- NSRCEL, IIM Bangalore
- Yashraj Research Foundation
- IISER, Pune

We are also grateful to government education officials, cluster heads, principals and teachers in Talasari whose permission, encouragement and cooperation have been essential to running the programme in schools.



Looking ahead

The next year is not simply about increasing the number of children in the programme. We want to improve the models as they grow.

Solve-with-Bharat

Work towards the longer-term goal of reaching 10,000 students, while improving Community Facilitator training, school observations and programme efficiency.

Paper Plus

Test how worksheet-based practice can support children who cannot receive regular in-school digital practice.

Read-a-story

Strengthen student participation, learning outcomes and the volunteer model across institutions and open volunteers.

Innovate 4 Education

Move from design into implementation and learn what students build, test and take back from the field.

Across all programs, the approach remains the same: do the work well, measure it, learn from it and improve it.



Our Journey: 2018-2026



2019

The first pilot expanded to 60 students, followed by a larger 200-student pilot.



2021-22

Read-a-story was adapted for new settings, including BMKT pilots of 50 and 60 students; RAS also moved towards a 1,000-student program.



2024-25

Read-a-story reached around 800 students. Solve-with-Bharat and the YRF partnership together reached about 2,064 students.



2026-2027

Target: to reach 10,000 students for Solve-with-Bharat and 500 students for Read-a-story

1



2018

Read-a-story began as a small prototype with about 10 - 12 students.

2



2020

The model reached a 500-student pilot.

3

4



2022-23

Alongside around 1,000 Read-a-story students, n+1 began its Foundational Numeracy pilot with around 1,000 students.

5

6



2025-26

Read-a-story worked with 387 students and 500 volunteers. Solve-with-Bharat expanded to 7,500+ students, with 43 core intervention schools and 39 Community Facilitators.

7

8

From a small reading experiment to a portfolio of learning programs

Acknowledgements

To the children

Thank you for taking part, trying new things, asking questions and giving us the opportunity to learn alongside you.

To our Community Facilitators

You are an important part of the work. You take the programme into schools, help children when they get stuck, keep records, solve problems and often learn new things yourselves.

To our volunteers

Thank you for the hours you gave, the questions you answered and the relationships you built with your students.

To our schools and teachers

Thank you for making space for our programs within already busy school days.

To our research and academic partners

Thank you for helping us ask better questions and look carefully at the evidence.



Our programmes are strengthened by people and organisations who believe in the work and choose to support it.
Their generosity gives us the resources and confidence to keep learning, improving and trying new ideas.



"Education is one of the greatest gifts we can give a child. NPlusOne has embarked on the mission to educate underprivileged children, with a focus on foundational math and language skills. Having worked closely with NPlusOne leadership, I've been inspired by their passion for making a positive impact and their pragmatic approach. I look forward to supporting NPlusOne in any way I can. Wishing the team success in this endeavour."

Rajan Bopardikar,
30 year veteran of Tech Industry



Dr. Lalit Shimpi



Mr. Ravi Sastry,
Festo India Private Limited
Grateful for your contribution in helping
us run the Solve-with-Bharat program



Mr. Vinay Kulkarni
Executive Chairman
Optima Life Sciences Pvt. Ltd

*Proud Donor of NPLUS ONE SOCIAL FOUNDATION :
My experience donating to NPLUS ONE has been incredibly fulfilling.
They go beyond rote textbook knowledge to fundamentally boost confidence of needy children predominantly from Remote and tribal areas.
They enjoy immense support from Volunteers especially youth and working professionals because of their flexible, work-from-home volunteering framework that allows people to teach children over a simple phone call. Their execution quality is also excellent and they ensure maximum legal credibility and transparency for every single donation that companies like us love to partner with them for CSR activities.
So any Individual, company want to make a real, structured difference, support them!*

Good work needs
good people behind it.



Thank you Jayashreeji and
Deepali Bapat.



Mr. Nitin Bapat
Dattatraya Pendse Memorial
Trust



ZP School, program kick off!



Full circle moment for us,
one of our fist students
contributing to n+1



Thank you Fornius for the phones



MoU signing with AISSMS,
thank you
Dr Sonali Jadhav

To our funders and supporters

Thank you for supporting both the implementation and the learning that comes with it.

To our mentors and partners

Thank you for the introductions, conversations, feedback, and practical help that often make the next step possible.

2025-26

There are many ways to describe a year. We could describe it through the number of children reached, volunteers, hours of reading, maths problems solved, learning gains, research or new ideas.

All of those are true.

But perhaps the most useful way to describe the year is through what we learnt.

We learnt that a simple reading session can become a meaningful relationship.

We learnt that children can make large gains in numeracy when they have the opportunity to practise at scale.

We learnt that a local young person can take on a meaningful professional role with the right training and support.

We learnt that not every pilot works equally well.

We learnt that technology can solve some problems, but people are still central to the model.

We learnt that research changes the questions we ask.

And we learnt that there is always more to understand.

That is where we end this year - with better evidence, better questions and a clearer idea of where we should put our effort next.

n+1 Social Foundation

Learning. Measuring. Improving.

Our Team

*MEET THE KEY PLAYERS IN OUR
ORGANIZATION*



Rahul Pathak



Gauri Mehendale



Amod Joshi



Anjali Desai



Pallavi Paranjape



Saarang Rajguru